UNIVERSITY OF THE WITWATERSRAND, JOHANNESBURG | WSoE Wits School of Education

WITS AHEAD RESEARCH GROUP

The AHEAD Fortnightly

Toleo 4 · 12 Novemba 2026 · Wits School of Education, University of the Witwatersrand

Kwa muda wa wiki mbili hizi, mjadala ulihama kutoka swali la kama wanafunzi wanatumia akili bandia, hadi swali la jinsi wanavyoitumia vizuri: tafiti mpya kutoka Australia, Afrika Kusini na Nigeria zinakubaliana kuwa mazoea na kina cha ushirikishwaji, si upatikanaji tu au jinsi sera inavyoandikwa, ndivyo vinavyotabiri ujifunzaji bora na matarajio bora kwa wahitimu. Taasisi zinaitikia kwa namna tofauti: nyingine zinageukia mitihani ya ana kwa ana na sera kali zaidi za udanganyifu, nyingine, zikiwemo Wits kupitia Global Higher Education Futures Centre yake mpya, zinachagua kujenga ufundishaji na uwezo wa utafiti badala yake. Takwimu za robo ya tatu kutoka Statistics South Africa zinatukumbusha kwa nini hili ni muhimu hapa: ukosefu wa ajira kwa vijana ulishuka kidogo tu hadi 47.3%, hivyo faida ya kila saa ya masomo bado inahitaji kupatikana kwa jitihada. Kwa Wits AHEAD, kazi inabaki ile ile: kuwasaidia wahitimu kubadilisha uwezo, si upatikanaji tu, kuwa fursa.

MAMBO MATATU YA KUJUA

1

NEWS · 11 NOVEMBER 2026 · UNITED KINGDOM

Office for Students tells universities to bring back in-person exams to protect assessment from AI

Office for Students ya Uingereza imeagiza vyuo vikuu kuzingatia kurejea kwenye mitihani ya ana kwa ana, mitihani ya vitabu vilivyofungwa, vivas na majaribio ya vitendo, ili kulinda uhalali wa tathmini wakati akili bandia ikizidi kusambaa. Mwongozo huo umetokana na utafiti wa miezi minne uliofanywa kwa ushirikiano na Advance HE, ukijumuisha mazungumzo na wanafunzi na wafanyakazi wapatao 300 katika zaidi ya taasisi 120, ambao ulibaini kuwa matumizi ya akili bandia yamesambaa sana na kuwa baadhi ya tathmini hazifai tena kwa kusudi lake. Hii ni mara ya kwanza mdhibiti huyo kueleza waziwazi mienendo ya akili bandia ya kitaasisi inayoweza kusababisha hatua, ikiwemo kushushwa kwa ubora wa tuzo.

> **Kwa nini ni muhimu:** Nguzo ya kwanza ya Wits AHEAD ni akili bandia zalishi katika elimu ya juu, ikiwemo tathmini na uadilifu wa kitaaluma; mdhibiti wa kitaifa anapohama kutoka ushauri kwenda hatua zenye matokeo halisi, ni ishara ambayo mifumo mingine, ikiwemo ya Afrika Kusini, inaelekea kuifuatilia.

Times Higher Education · timeshighereducation.com · **Soma kwenye chanzo**

Luckhurst, G. (2026, November 11). OfS pushes in-person exams to 'protect sector's reputation'. *Times Higher Education*. timeshighereducation.com/news/ofs-pushes-person-exams-protect-sectors-reputation

2

REPORT · 11 NOVEMBER 2026 · UNITED KINGDOM

Graduates' wellbeing and civic contribution should be tracked alongside pay, British Academy argues

British Academy inasema vigezo vinavyotumika sasa kupima mafanikio ya wahitimu vinajikita kwa ufinyu zaidi kwenye mshahara, na inataka pia ufuatiliaji wa uwiano wa kazi na maisha, afya ya muda mrefu na ushiriki wa kiraia. Inarejelea utafiti wa serikali uliobaini kuwa asilimia 24 ya wahitimu hujihusisha na kujitolea rasmi angalau kila mwezi, ikilinganishwa na asilimia 17 ya wasio wahitimu, na inapendekeza kuunganisha data za elimu ya juu na data za afya na uhalifu ili kujenga picha kamili zaidi.

> **Kwa nini ni muhimu:** Nguzo ya nne ya Wits AHEAD inahusu uwezo wa wahitimu na uwezo wa kuajirika zaidi ya kazi ya kwanza; wito wa taasisi ya kitaifa kutaka vigezo pana zaidi vya matokeo unahusiana moja kwa moja na jinsi kundi hili linavyotafsiri "mafanikio" kwa watahiniwa wake.

British Academy, reported by Times Higher Education · timeshighereducation.com · **Soma kwenye chanzo**

Luckhurst, G. (2026, November 11). Graduates' work-life balance 'should be tracked alongside pay'. *Times Higher Education*. timeshighereducation.com/news/graduates-work-life-balance-should-be-tracked-alongside-pay

3

REPORT · 10 NOVEMBER 2026 · SOUTH AFRICA

Youth unemployment eases slightly to 47.3% as overall unemployment rises to 33.7% in the third quarter of 2026

Kiwango rasmi cha ukosefu wa ajira kiliongezeka kwa alama 0.1 za asilimia hadi 33.7% katika robo ya tatu (Q3) ya 2026, huku ajira ikiongezeka kwa 101,000 hadi milioni 16.8, lakini nguvu kazi ikikua kwa kasi zaidi. Ukosefu wa ajira kwa vijana (miaka 15 hadi 34) ulishuka kwa alama 0.1 hadi 47.3%: vijana wasio na ajira walipungua kwa 23,000 hadi milioni 5.0, huku vijana walioajiriwa wakipungua kwa 5,000 hadi milioni 5.5.

> **Kwa nini ni muhimu:** Hii ni takwimu inayotumiwa na kikundi kwa njia za wahitimu na mabadiliko ya haki. Nguzo ya 4 inauliza iwapo akili bandia inapunguza au kupanua pengo hili kwa kundi hili hasa.

Statistics South Africa · statssa.gov.za · **Soma kwenye chanzo**

Statistics South Africa. (2026, November 10). *Quarterly Labour Force Survey (QLFS): Q3 2026* [Press release]. statssa.gov.za/publications/P0211/Media%20Release%20QLFS%20Q3%202026.pdf

UTAFITI NA RIPOTI

Wits opens a Global Higher Education Futures Centre, with a dedicated generative AI pedagogy hub

University of the Witwatersrand · 9 November 2026 · Pillar 6: Responsible AI and policy. Kwa Nguzo ya 6, chuo kikuu cha Afrika Kusini kinajenga mfumo wake wa kufikiria kuhusu usumbufu wa akili bandia katika elimu ya juu, badala ya kukopi mfumo uliobuniwa mahali pengine, jambo ambalo ndilo hasa mtazamo unaoongozwa na Kusini mwa Dunia na unaozingatia usawa ambao Wits AHEAD ipo kuusaidia.

University of the Witwatersrand. (2026, November 9). Wits launches the Global Higher Education Futures Centre. wits.ac.za/news/latest-news/research-news/2026/2026-11/wits-launches-the-global-higher-education-futures-centre.html

AI-generated 'slop' papers published under prominent academics' names without their consent

Times Higher Education · 9 November 2026 · Pillar 6: Responsible AI and policy. Kwa Nguzo ya 6, tukio hili linaonyesha jinsi AI zalishi inavyoweza kutumika kutunga si tu matokeo ya utafiti bali hata utambulisho wa watafiti wenyewe, ndiyo sababu sera ya AI inayowajibika kwa elimu ya juu lazima ifike mpaka uadilifu wa uchapishaji, isisimame darasani tu.

Asaf, S. (2026, November 9). 'AI slop' papers published under prominent academics' names. *Times Higher Education*. timeshighereducation.com/news/ai-slop-papers-published-under-prominent-academics-names

Wording of university generative AI policies shapes how students and teachers actually behave, study finds

arXiv preprint (University of Maryland and University of Iowa researchers) · 8 November 2026 · Pillar 1: Generative AI in higher education. Kwa Nguzo ya 1, utafiti huu ni ukumbusho kuwa sera ya akili bandia zalishi ni nzuri kadri ya maneno yake tu: vyuo vikuu vinavyoandika au kurekebisha kanuni zao za akili bandia katika ufundishaji na tathmini vinahitaji kupima si tu kile kanuni inachokiruhusu, bali jinsi wanafunzi na wafanyakazi watakavyosoma na kutenda kulingana na maneno yenyewe.

Mehreen, S., Yuan, X., Nithyanand, R., & Hoque, N. (2026). *Wording matters: Understanding how GenAI policy rules shape teachers' and students' workflows and perceptions*. arXiv. arxiv.org/abs/2611.11072

How deeply students engage with an AI chat, not how often they use it, predicts better coursework, large Australian study finds

University of Queensland and Monash University (arXiv preprint, submitted to the Journal of Computer Assisted Learning) · 8 November 2026 · Pillar 2: Analytics for student success. Kwa Nguzo ya 2, matokeo haya ni muhimu kwa taasisi yoyote inayojenga uchanganuzi kuhusu matumizi ya zana za akili bandia: kuhesabu mara ngapi wanafunzi wanafungua kibonyezo cha mazungumzo hakuambii mengi kuhusu ujifunzaji, hivyo mifumo iliyokusudiwa kusaidia mafanikio ya wanafunzi inahitaji kuangalia kina cha ushirikiano, si mara ngapi wanabonyeza.

Zhuang, X., Bakharia, A., Gašević, D., & Khosravi, H. (2026). *From dialogue to task: How cognitive engagement with generative artificial intelligence relates to post-dialogue activity and task outcomes*. arXiv. arxiv.org/abs/2611.11435

TAZAMA

▶ World Bank video: 'small AI', not big models alone, can widen opportunity in developing-economy education and jobs (1 hr 16 min)

World Bank Group (YouTube). Katika Mkutano wa Kimataifa wa Akili Bandia na Dijitali uliofanyika Seoul, uliorekodiwa na Kikundi cha Benki ya Dunia, Rais wake Ajay Banga alifungua jopo la majadiliano kuhusu jinsi vifaa vya "akili bandia ndogo", vinavyofaa na kuzingatia hali za mitaa, badala ya mifumo mikubwa ya jumla tu, vinavyoweza kupanua fursa katika uchumi unaoendelea. Waziri wa Mawasiliano, Ubunifu na Uchumi wa Kidijitali wa Nigeria, Bosun Tijani, alijiunga na Afisa Mtendaji Mkuu wa Tridge, Hoshik Shin, na mwanzilishi wa Amini, Kate Kallot, kujadili elimu, kilimo na huduma za umma, pamoja na sehemu kuhusu mafunzo yaliyopatikana kutokana na matumizi ya akili bandia katika elimu nchini El Salvador. Jopo hilo lilitaja data za mitaa zinazotegemeka, muunganisho wa bei nafuu, uwezo wa kompyuta, ujuzi na mifumo ya ununuzi kama masharti yanayowezesha wabunifu wa mitaa kukuza suluhisho zao za akili bandia.

KUTOKA KWA KIKUNDI

12 Septemba 2026 **Ushirikiano: Australia inajiunga na ramani ya Footprint, ushirikiano na Chuo Kikuu cha Murdoch, Perth, ukiendelea kukua**
Kuchunguza kazi ya pamoja kuhusu akili bandia na elimu kati ya Wits na Murdoch; hati ya mapatano iko katika maandalizi.

12 Septemba 2026 **Ripoti ya utafiti wa shahada ya uzamili imekamilika kwa sifa ya pekee; mhitimu atahitimu Desemba 2026**
Mapitio ya bibliometriki ya uongozi unaotegemea data na ubunifu wa sera; mhitimu huyo sasa anaendelea na pendekezo la shahada ya uzamivu.

12 Septemba 2026 **Tasnifu ya shahada ya uzamivu imekamilika; mhitimu atahitimu Desemba 2026**
Marekebisho yaliyohitajika na wakadiriaji yamekubaliwa katika utafiti kuhusu wanafunzi wa masomo ya mbali waliofanya vizuri sana katika elimu ya juu ya Afrika Mashariki.

MAKALA TUNAZOPENDEKEZA KUSOMA

Development as Freedom Amartya Sen, Oxford University Press (1999). Herufi H katika AHEAD. Anzia hapa.

With best wishes for the fortnight ahead,

Director: Wits AHEAD

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